

SHIELDRUNNER

Player's manual — Amstrad CPC 6128



The loading screen

Shieldrunner is an original action game for the Amstrad CPC 6128. You ride the Runner, a great long-legged beast, around the rim of four frontier planets, keeping their shield generators charged while the enemy pours in.

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1. The job

Each planet is protected by a shield, kept up by **four shield generators** spread around its rim. The generators drain all the time, each at its own rate. Your job is to keep them charged until the planet's clock runs out.

- If **three** generators are drained at once, the shield fails and the game is over.
- If your **energy** runs out, you fall and the game is over.
- Hold out until the time runs out and the planet is safe: on to the next.

Save all four planets and you have won.

2. What you need and loading

You need an **Amstrad CPC 6128**, a **6128 Plus**, or any CPC with 64K of extra memory, or an emulator such as Caprice32, WinAPE or ACE-DL. On a CPC with only 64K the loader says so and stops.

Put the disc in and type:

RUN"SHIELD

First the **Revive8bit** screen appears. It stays for 10 seconds; press **Space** to go on at once.



The Revive8bit screen

Then the **loading screen** appears and stays while the game loads.



The loading screen while the game loads

Leave the disc in the drive. Each planet is loaded from it when you reach it.

3. The title screen

The title screen shows the first planet with the title over its sky. Below it, two pages take turns every few seconds: a reminder of how to play, and the **high-score table**.



The title: how to play

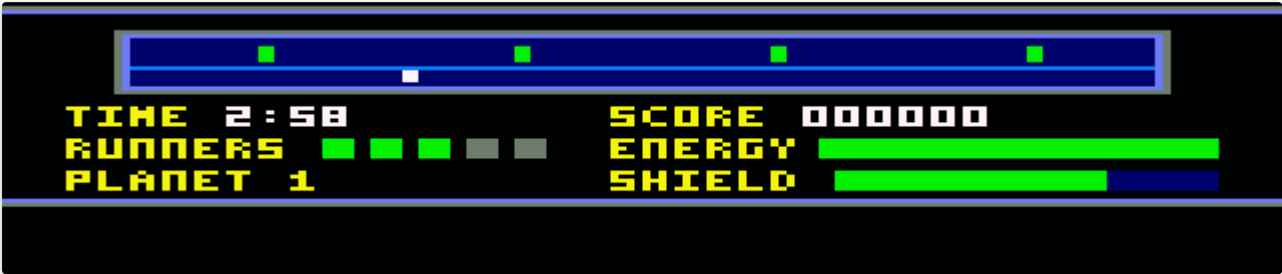


The title: the high scores

Press **fire** to start. **M** turns the music off or on, here and in the game.

4. The screen

The top of the screen is the **playfield**: the planet's surface, scrolling as you ride. Below it is the **panel**:



The panel

- **Radar** (the long strip): the whole planet, all the way round. The four squares are the generators: **green** holding, **flashing** unstable (see to it soon), **red** drained. The white mark is you.
- **TIME**: how long you still have to hold the shield.
- **RUNNERS**: your spare Runners (green squares).
- **PLANET**: which planet you are on (1 to 4).
- **SCORE**: your score.
- **ENERGY**: your own energy. Green, then yellow below half, red below a quarter.
- **SHIELD**: the charge of the generator nearest you, in the colour of its state.

5. Controls

Use a **joystick**, or the **cursor keys** with **Space** to fire.

Input	Riding	On foot
Left / Right	Ride: the Runner speeds up, skids round to turn, coasts to a stop	Walk (the screen does not scroll)
Up	Jump	Aim up
Fire	Shoot forward	Shoot forward
Fire + Up	Shoot diagonally up	Shoot straight up, or diagonally with Left / Right
Fire + Down	Get off	Get on (standing at the Runner)
Down (held)		Recharge, standing at a generator
W		Whistle for the Runner, or for a spare

Key	
P	Pause. P again goes on; Esc gives up the game
M	Music off or on (the sound effects stay)

6. Riding the Runner

On the Runner you are fast: it speeds up to the speed of the scrolling screen, and the view keeps it in the middle. To turn round, push the other way: it skids, slows and turns. Let go and it coasts to a stop.



Riding, firing at a drifter

Press **up** to **jump**. Jumping is the way over **crawlers**, which walk along the ground.



Jumping

Riding, you shoot forward, or diagonally up with fire and up together.

7. On foot: recharging the generators

The generators can only be recharged on foot. Ride to the generator, press **fire and down** to get off (the Runner waits where it stands), walk to the generator's base and **hold down**. The rider plugs in and the generator charges slowly.



Recharging: the core flashes white

While you hold down, the generator's **core pulses**. Press **fire while it flashes white** to pump in a big boost of charge. Press fire at the wrong time and charging **stalls** for a second. Let go of down to unplug.

On foot the screen does not scroll, and you walk slowly. Fire with up shoots straight up, or diagonally with left or right. To get back on, stand at the Runner and press **fire and down**.

8. The generators and the shield

The radar shows every generator's state. A **flashing** generator is running low: go to it. A **red** generator is drained: a **breach** opens and a wave of enemies pours out of it.

With **two** generators drained, the **breach carrier** comes: a great saucer that takes **twelve bolts** to bring down and bombs you from above. With **three** drained, the shield fails and the game is over.



Two generators drained: the breach carrier

A drained generator can still be recharged: it comes back as you charge it.

9. The enemies

	Enemy	What it does	How to beat it
	Drifter	Floats towards you and explodes against you	Shoot it before it reaches you
	Tracker	Sweeps overhead dropping bombs	It hangs still for a moment after each bomb: shoot straight up then
	Crawler	Walks the ground at you	Jump it when riding; shoot it on foot
	Thrower	Walks into view and lobs rocks that land where you stand	Keep moving, walk at it and shoot
	Breach carrier	Comes with two generators drained; bombs from above	Twelve bolts
	Energy cell	Sometimes left by a shot enemy; falls to the ground	Touch it for a quarter of your energy back

10. Your Runner, spares and energy



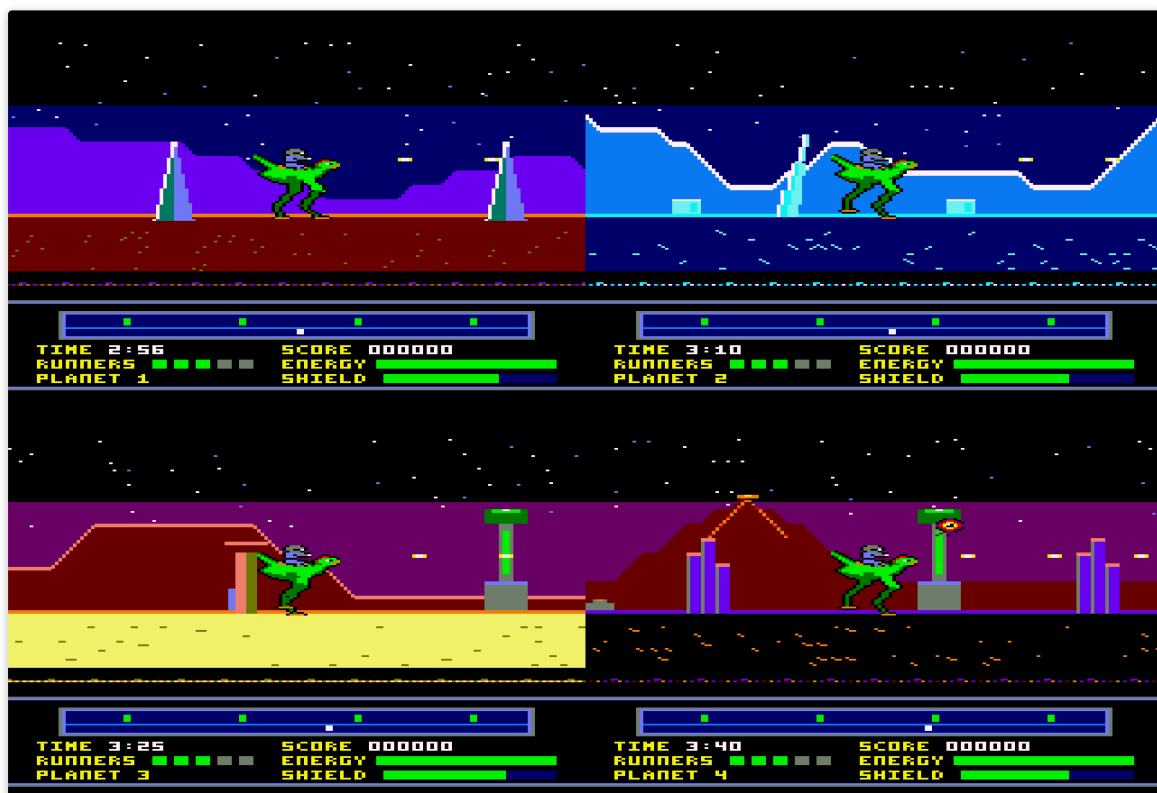
Riding, hits fall on the **Runner**. Each costs you a little energy, but after **three hits** the Runner dies and throws you off. After any hit you flash for a moment and cannot be hit again.

On foot, every hit costs you a lot more energy, and knocks you off a generator you are charging.

Press **W** to **whistle**: your Runner runs over to you and waits. If it is dead, a **spare** comes in from the edge of the screen (you start with three, shown under RUNNERS). With no spares left, no Runner comes.

Your **energy** is full at the start of each planet. Energy cells give some back.

11. The planets



The four planets

#	Planet	Its enemies	Time
1	Ferros , the rust moon	a bit of everything	3:00
2	Glacis , the ice world	trackers swarm	3:15
3	Mesa Ra , the desert	crawlers and throwers	3:30
4	Pyre , the volcanic world	everything, faster	3:45

Each planet's generators drain faster and start lower than the last.

12. Pausing and giving up

Press **P** to pause: the picture stops and the sound goes quiet. **P** again goes on; **Esc** gives up the game.



Paused

13. Clearing a planet, scoring and high scores

When the time runs out with the shield still up, the planet is clear. The energy you have left and the charge in the generators make a **bonus**. Then the next planet loads, and you go on with your score and spare Runners and a full energy bar.



Planet clear, with the bonus

Shot down	Points
Drifter	10
Tracker	20
Crawler	20
Thrower	30
Breach carrier	200

At the end of a game, a score good enough for the table asks for your **initials**: **up** and **down** choose a letter, **fire** takes it.



A new high score

The high-score table is kept until you switch off: it is not saved to disc.

14. Tips

- Watch the radar. Go to a **flashing** generator before it turns red.
- Ride to a generator and get off right beside it: the Runner waits there for you.
- Pump with **fire on the white flash** only. A wrong press costs a second.
- **Crawlers**: jump them when riding. On foot, shoot them from afar.
- **Trackers** hang still just after they bomb: shoot straight up then.
- **Throwers** stop to lob their rocks: walk at them and shoot.
- Pick up **energy cells**. They fall where an enemy was shot.
- Don't let two generators drain: the breach carrier is hard work.

Shieldrunner is an original game for the Amstrad CPC 6128, inspired by Rimrunner (Palace Software, 1988).